

# Ayla Myers

Senior game developer and team lead with 15 years of professional experience and a proven track record of releasing quality games on time.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Lead Game Engineer & Producer *Doborog* ..... May 2022–Sep 2025

- Released "Clone Drone in the Hyperdome" 📀, a virtual reality sword-fighting Unity game, garnering Very Positive reviews on Steam and 4.6 stars on the Meta store.
- Extensively optimized draw call performance to hit Meta's VRC targets using techniques like GPU instancing, texture atlases, imposters, and baked lighting.
- Established timelines, set release dates, coordinated launch plans, managed project dependencies, and ensured project delivery avoiding "development hell."
- Juiced up voxel destruction with custom fragment shaders and voxel byte data.
- Rebuilt and took ownership of CI/CD pipelines and DevOps infrastructure.

### Unity Game Programmer *Vodeo Games* ..... Mar 2020–Feb 2022

- Released "Beast Breaker" 📀 to the Epic Games store and Nintendo Switch, referred to as "the epitome of a hidden gem" on Nintendo Life and scoring a 9/10.
- Implemented turn-based combat mechanics, particles, polish, and juice.
- Made an inverse kinematics workflow powered by Burst-compiled animation jobs.
- Developed a game serialization and autosave system compatible across platforms.

### Lead Game Programmer *Sweet Baby Inc.* ..... Jan 2020–Aug 2021

- Released "Lost Your Marbles" 📀, a quirky narrative marble game for the Playdate.
- Designed a 2D physics engine optimized to run on CPU-limited hardware.
- Created a narrative event system to support the complex branching storyline.
- Mentored two teams of junior developers through the entire lifecycle of developing their own games for the Playdate: "Reel Steal" and "Recommendation Dog."

### Game Designer & Founder *8-Bit Mischief LLC* ..... Feb 2018–Mar 2021

- Independently developed several small web games and PICO-8 games such as "Just One Boss" 📀 which received millions of plays across dozens of sites.
- Presented at industry events like Play NYC, PAX East, MAGFest, and No Quarter.
- Personally handled social media, marketing, and the sale of games to sites.

### Game Programmer & React Engineer *Castle* ..... Dec 2018–Oct 2019

- Created a dozen example online multiplayer Lua games as learning resources.
- Implemented features like analytics for the React-based game platform itself.
- Identified market opportunities and researched platform competitors.

**Engineering Manager & Team Lead** *Aaptiv* ..... Jun 2018—Mar 2019

- Lead a four-person engineering team tasked with growing and refining a React-based conversion funnel, using metrics and A/B tests to maximize CTR.
- Implemented auto-login support, user behavior tracking, and attribution.

**Senior Software Engineer & Tech Lead** *Etsy* ..... Aug 2015—Sep 2017

- Co-lead a product team up to and through the public launch of Etsy Studio.
- Mentored junior engineers, helping them advance their web development careers.

**Software Engineer** *AppNexus* ..... May 2013—Aug 2015

- Built unit-tested JavaScript modules and APIs for real-time bidding software.

**Software Engineer** *IBM* ..... Sep 2011—May 2013

- Developed JavaScript widgets for IBM's business process management suite.

## TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

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Multiplayer Game Networking: The Brute Force Approach!  *Deconstruct* ..... Jul 2019

PRIDE Panel *Playcrafting* ..... Jun 2019

Let's expand the meaning of "GAME FEEL"!!  *!!con* ..... May 2019

Gettin' started makin' games *Catskills Conf* ..... Oct 2018

Procedural Landscape Generation *Never Graduate Week* ..... May 2018

The joys of PICO-8 token crunching!!  *!!con* ..... May 2018

"Oh No" Moments in Games *Playcrafting* ..... Mar 2018

Meet & Code Pair Programming Workshop *Recurse Center* ..... Jan 2018

Wave Function Collapse  *Code As Craft* ..... Jun 2017

Networking Real-Time Multiplayer Games *QueensJS* ..... Nov 2016

Makin' Pixel Art *Etsy* ..... Mar 2016

## SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

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**Game Engines:** Unity (8+ years of experience), Godot (5+ years), Unreal (on-and-off)

**Asset Creation:** Photoshop, Blender, Aseprite

**Web Development:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, TypeScript, JSON, Node, React, Next.js

**Languages:** C#, GDScript, GLSL, Lua, Bash, Python, SQL, Java, etc.

## EDUCATION

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**Recurse Center** ..... 2017–2018

Self-directed twelve-week retreat for creative programmers.

**Rochester Institute of Technology** ..... 2007–2010

B.S. in Information Science and Technology.

**Cornell University** ..... Summer 2005 & 2006